

swipe left to get to the Now Playing screen. Once you are there, locate the device you want to stream to from the list on the right, and choose it. Voila, you're done. iPhone users will have to click the AirPlay icon to open up the list and MacOS users will have to click on the AirPlay icon in their menu bar. Just make sure that both your Apple TV/Speakers and your streaming device is awake and connected to the same WiFi network for AirPlay to recognise both devices.

It's getting better!

One of the main deterrents for not using Airplay was that it is a monogamous relationship – you pair your iOS device with the receiver and that's it. You don't get any of the new fancy multi-room audio setups; hell, you even have to stay in the same room for ensuring connection stability. And if you wanted to stream to more than one device at a time, you had to boot up iTunes on a computer. But all of that is set to change very soon. Airplay 2 is coming this fall along with iOS 11 and it promises several amazing features over regular AirPlay, with multi-room streaming being the most prominent.

Conduct your own AirDrops without a helicopter nor a starving nation to worry about!

AirDrop while sort of similar in idea, is a whole different ball game altogether. While AirPlay's streaming protocols have been reverse engineered (and thereby opening up a whole new avenue of third party receivers to stream to), the protocols for transferring data that is employed by AirDrop still remain extremely confidential. Which is a good thing for Apple, in hindsight, because the ability to AirDrop stuff is one of major contributing factors for people buying into the whole ecosystem. To put it very simply, AirDrop is a service that lets you transfer unlimited data between two systems wirelessly. Or the next best thing to unlimited anyway – there have been forum reports of users successfully transferring 10+GB single files over AirDrop. We can't think of any more extreme consumer level use cases than that so it's pretty darn impressive. The protocol allows you to send documents, photos, web pages, map locations, music files.... Basically pretty much anything you want, to nearby devices. It's all encrypted via TLS Encryption.

It was released along side OS X Lion back in 2011 and was baked into iOS 7 in 2013. The thing was, you couldn't transfer files between a Mac and an iPhone with AirDrop, owing to two completely different protocols – the iPhone requiring both a WiFi *and* a Bluetooth connection while the